



# READING COMPREHENSION

KU30003\_English III TOEFL Preparation Class

Week 15\_Session 1



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# OUTLINE

- Strategies for TOEFL Reading Comprehension (Skills 12-13)
- Reading Quiz

# REVIEW

# OBJECTIVE

Students are able to correctly answer questions in Reading comprehension section in TOEFL ITP-like test using the following strategies:

Skill 12: Determine where specific information is found

Skill 13: Determine the tone, purpose or course



# STRATEGIES FOR THE READING COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS:

- ✓ Reading Comprehension consists of 50 questions for 55 minutes.
- ✓ FAQ: main ideas, directly answered questions (based on the text), implications of the text, and vocabulary.
- ✓ Be familiar with the directions.
- ✓ Do **not spend too much time** on the reading.
- ✓ The texts might be about **something unfamiliar to you**, but do not worry because all the information you need is in the text.
- ✓ Never leave any answer blank.

# STRATEGIES IN READING

- Skimming: To find main ideas or gist of the text
- Scanning: To find specific information/detail (use keywords)
- Check out the questions first to determine the type of the questions and what information needs to find
- Read the passage which contains the answer carefully
- Choose the best answer

# READING COMPREHENSION

# SKILL 12: DETERMINE WHERE SPECIFIC INFORMATION IS FOUND

- **Common Questions:**

Where in the passage does the author mention ..... ?

- **Where to Find the Answer**

The answer can be in any of the lines listed in the answers to the question.



# SKILL 12: DETERMINE WHERE SPECIFIC INFORMATION IS FOUND

## How to answer

1. Choose a **keyword** or idea in the question.
2. **Skim the lines in the passage** that are listed in the answers to the questions. You should skim for the keyword or idea.
3. **Read** the sentence that contains the keyword or idea carefully.
4. **Choose the answer** that contains the line numbers of a restatement of the question.
5. Never leave any answer blank.

# SKILL 12

## Example

### The passage:

Line Meteor Crater, a great crater approximately 40 miles east of  
(5) Flagstaff, Arizona, is generally thought by scientists to have formed  
as a result of the impact of a 60,000-ton meteor about 50,000 years  
ago. The meteor, made of nickel and iron, disintegrated on impact  
and spread half a billion tons of rock over the surface of the land.  
The massiveness of the meteor can only be imagined from the  
mammoth size of the crater, which measures a mile in diameter  
and three miles around the top. The rim of the crater rises more  
than 150 feet above the plain where the meteor impacted and is  
(10) visible for more than ten miles on a clear day.

### The questions:

1. Where in the passage does the author discuss the composition of the meteor?  
(A) Lines 1–4  
(B) Lines 4–5  
(C) Lines 6–8  
(D) Lines 8–10
2. Where in the passage does the author mention the distance from which the crater can be seen?  
(A) Lines 1–4  
(B) Lines 4–5  
(C) Lines 6–8  
(D) Lines 9–10

# SKILL 13: DETERMINE THE TONE, PURPOSE OR COURSE

- **Common questions**

**Tone: emotion or attitude of the author**

**Purpose: the objective of the author**

**In which course: the subject or the type of class or group of people**

- **Where to Find the Answer**

Look from the topic of the passage (main ideas) and the supporting details.

# SKILL 13: DETERMINE THE TONE, PURPOSE OR COURSE

## How to answer

**Tone:** Skim the passage looking for **clues** that the author is showing some **emotion**.

**Purpose:** Skim the main idea in the **topic sentence and the details** used to support the main idea.

**Course:** Study the main idea in the **topic sentence and details** used to support the main idea.



# SKILL 13

## Example

### The passage:

Line Military awards have long been considered symbolic of  
(5) royalty, and thus when the United States was a young nation just  
finished with revolution and eager to distance itself from anything  
tasting of monarchy, there was strong sentiment against military  
decoration. For a century, from the end of the Revolutionary War  
until the Civil War, the United States awarded no military honors.  
The institution of the Medal of Honor in 1861 was a source of great  
discussion and concern. From the Civil War until World War I, the  
Medal of Honor was the only military award given by the United  
(10) States government, and today it is awarded only in the most  
extreme cases of heroism. Although the United States is still  
somewhat wary of granting military awards, several awards have  
been instituted since World War I.

### The questions:

1. The *tone* of the passage is
  - (A) angered
  - (B) humorous
  - (C) outraged
  - (D) informational
2. The author's *purpose* in this passage is to
  - (A) describe the history of military awards from the Revolutionary War to the Civil War
  - (B) demonstrate an effect of America's attitude toward royalty
  - (C) give an opinion of military awards
  - (D) outline various historical symbols of royalty
3. The passage would probably be assigned reading in a *course* on
  - (A) general science
  - (B) psychology
  - (C) American history
  - (D) interior decoration

# REFERENCE:

Philips, D. (2003). *Longman Preparation Course for the TOEFL Test*.  
New york: Pearson Education